

10 > Installing and Configuring Linux

3. **Allocate Resources:** Assign CPU, RAM, and disk space based on system requirements.
4. **Attach ISO Image:** In the VM settings, attach the Linux ISO file.
5. **Install Linux:** Start the VM and follow the installation steps as you would on a physical machine.

QEMU/KVM

QEMU and Kernel-based Virtual Machine (KVM) provide a powerful virtualization solution for Linux users, offering near-native performance.

Steps to Set Up QEMU/KVM:

1. **Install QEMU and KVM:** Use your package manager (`sudo apt install qemu-kvm libvirt-daemon-system` for Ubuntu, or `dnf install qemu-kvm libvirt` for Fedora).
2. **Enable Virtualization:** Ensure virtualization is enabled in the BIOS/UEFI settings.
3. **Create a Virtual Machine:** Use `virt-manager` or the command line to create and configure a VM.
4. **Attach ISO and Install:** Select the Linux ISO, allocate resources, and complete the installation.

Both VirtualBox and QEMU/KVM provide robust virtualization options depending on user preferences and hardware capabilities.

Post-Installation Setup

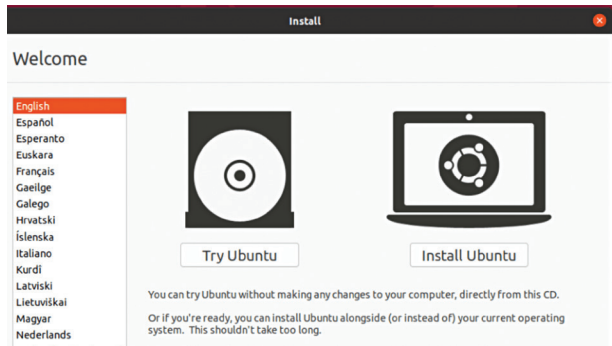
Package Managers: apt, dnf, pacman, and zypper

Once Linux is installed, managing software efficiently is key to maintaining a stable system. Different distributions use distinct package managers:

- **apt (Advanced Package Tool):** Used in Debian-based distributions like Ubuntu. Commands include `apt update`, `apt upgrade`, and `apt install package_name`.

```
jwallen@ubuntu-clean: /etc/apt
nano 2.6.3      File: sources.list

#deb cdrom:[Ubuntu 16.10 _Yakkety Yak_ - Release amd64 (201610)
# See http://help.ubuntu.com/community/UpgradeNotes for how to
# newer versions of the distribution.
deb http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety main restric
# deb-src http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety main r
## Major bug fix updates produced after the final release of
## distribution.
deb http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety-updates main
# deb-src http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety-updates
## N.B. software from this repository is ENTIRELY UNSUPPORTED
## team. Also, please note that software in universe WILL NOT
## review or updates from the Ubuntu security team.
deb http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety universe
# deb-src http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety univer
deb http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety-updates univ
# deb-src http://us.archive.ubuntu.com/ubuntu/ yakkety-update
```



- **dnf:** The successor to yum, used in Fedora and RHEL-based distributions. Commands follow a similar structure: `dnf install package_name`.
- **pacman:** The package manager for Arch Linux and its derivatives. The syntax includes `pacman -Syu` for updates and `pacman -S package_name` for installation.
- **zypper:** Used in openSUSE. Common commands include `zypper refresh` and `zypper install package_name`. Familiarizing yourself with the package manager of your distribution allows for efficient installation, updates, and system maintenance.

Configuring Repositories and Third-Party Software

Package managers pull software from repositories, which are official or third-party sources containing precompiled software packages. Configuring repositories correctly ensures access to the latest updates and security patches.

- **Adding Repositories:** Some distributions require enabling extra repositories for additional software. For instance, Fedora users might enable RPM Fusion with `dnf install https://download1.rpmfusion.org/free/fedora/rpmfusion-free-release-$(rpm -E %fedora).noarch.rpm`.
- **Third-Party Software:** Some proprietary applications, like Google Chrome or Visual Studio Code, require manual addition of their repositories or downloading `.deb` or `.rpm` files.

Setting Up User Accounts and sudo Privileges

User management is crucial for system security and efficiency. By default, most Linux installations create a primary user account, but additional accounts can be added with `useradd` and `passwd`.

- **Granting sudo Access:** To allow a user administrative privileges, add them to the sudo group with `usermod -aG sudo user-name` (Debian-based) or `usermod -aG wheel username` (RHEL-based).
- **Securing the System:** It is advisable to disable the root account's direct login to prevent unauthorized access. This can be done by editing the `/etc/ssh/sshd_config` file and setting `PermitRootLogin no`. **[d]**